

Everyone Else • 13/39 • Fatima bint Asad

The Woman Who Raised Him First. Fatima bint Asad raised the Prophet inside her own house before she ever raised her own son, Imam Ali. Five items, no event print, dateless.

One style for the whole line — Fraunces and Nunito Sans, cut paper, the person on a stamp. Still open where it shows: the fact panel is TO VERIFY and the return address is not set.

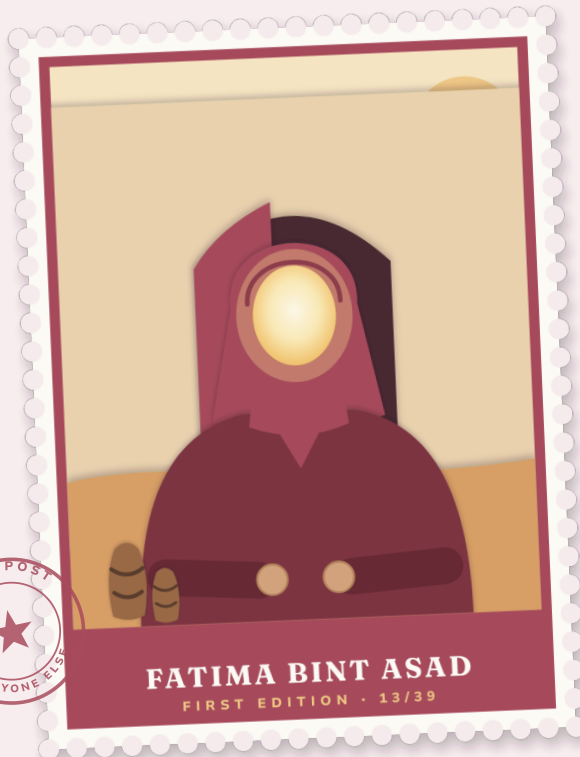
ENVELOPE — C5, 229 × 162 MM

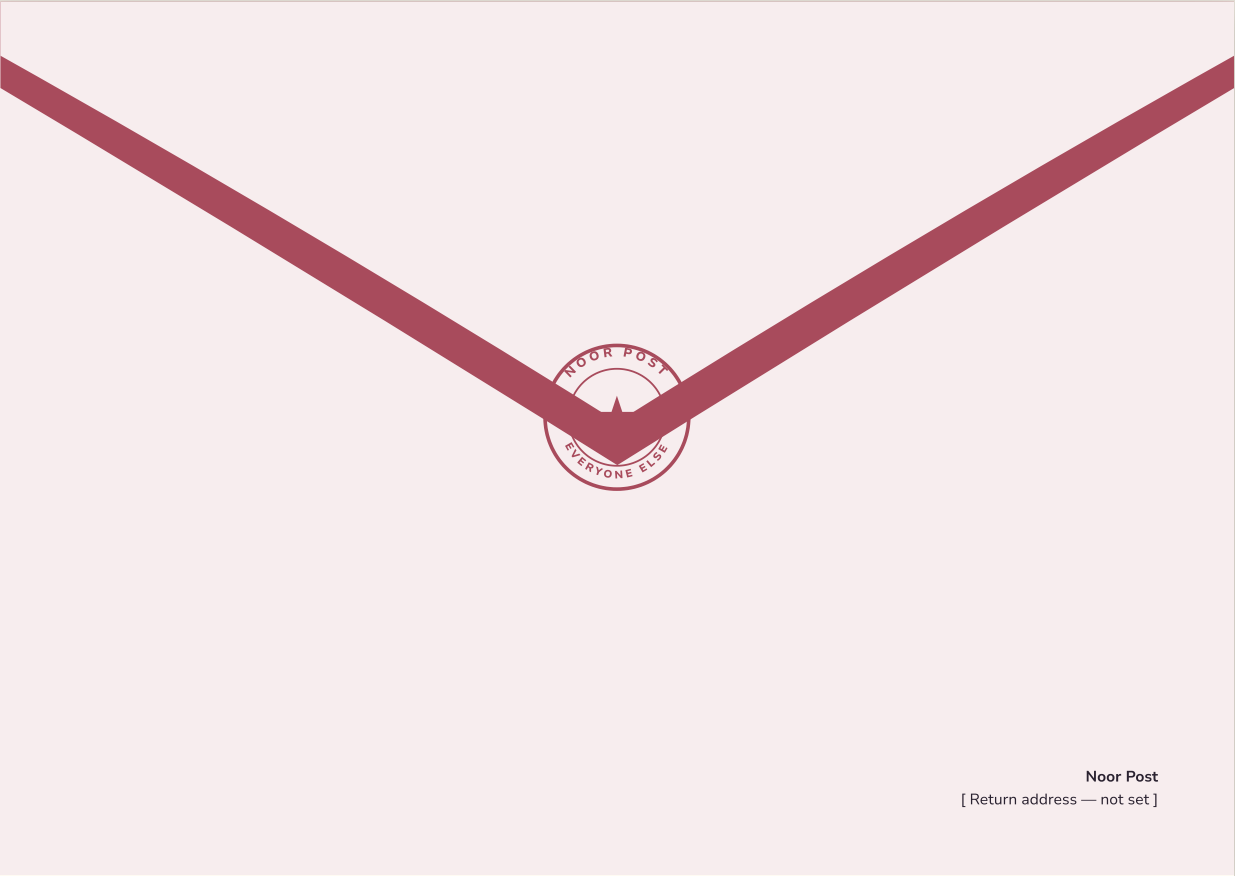
NOOR POST · EVERYONE ELSE

Fatima bint Asad raised the Prophet inside her own house before she ever raised her own son, Imam Ali.

FOR

[Child's name]





INSIDE THE FLAP

EVERYONE ELSE · FATIMA
BINT ASAD · INSIDE THE
FLAP

Open together.

● is the grown-up. ○ is you.

- 1 The letter — read it out loud, ● and ○ taking turns
- 2 The hadith card
- 3 The print
- 4 The stickers
- 5 The postcard

Fatima bint Asad

- **Who she was.** Wife of Abu Talib, mother of Imam Ali, and — by long-standing account — the woman who raised the Prophet inside her household after he was orphaned.
- **What she is remembered for.** Treating the young Muhammad as her own child, without distinction from her own sons, years before Imam Ali was born.
- **What is traditionally told about Imam Ali's birth.** *Traditionally told: that she gave birth to him inside the Kaaba itself.*
- **What the Prophet did at her death.** By most accounts, he gave her his own shirt to be buried in, and lay in her grave before she was placed there — a mark of honour he showed almost no one else.
- **Why she is in this envelope.** *Fatima bint Asad raised the Prophet inside her own house before she ever raised her own son, Imam Ali.*

She lived to see her son grown, and died while he was still finding his place beside the Prophet.

The Woman Who Raised Him First

• is the grown-up • ◦ is you • •◦ is together

- Years before Imam Ali was born, there was a boy in that house who was not her son. An orphan. He was being raised there anyway.

◦ Whose was he?

- His name was Muhammad. Both his parents had died before he was old enough to remember them properly, and his grandfather had died after that. So he came to his uncle's house, and his uncle's wife was Fatima bint Asad.

◦ Was she kind to him?

- More than kind. She fed him before her own children when there was not enough. She never let the house treat him like a visitor, and a house will do that to an orphan without anyone deciding to.

◦ Did he notice?

- He never forgot it. Years later, when she died in Medina, he called her his mother out loud, in front of people who knew exactly whose son he was.

◦ What did he do?

THE WOMAN WHO RAISED HIM FIRST · CONTINUED

- He gave her his own shirt to be buried in. By most accounts he lay down in the grave himself before she was put into it. He did that for almost nobody.

◦ **Did she have her own children?**

- Several. One of them was Ali. And here is the part worth stopping on: years later, when that house fell on hard times, the orphan she had taken in took her son into his own home and raised him.

◦ **The other way round?**

- The other way round exactly. She raised him when he had nobody. He raised her son when the family needed it. Neither of them was keeping a ledger, and it came out even anyway.

◦ **Why so much?**

- Because she chose him. Nobody made her. There was no word for what she was to him and no one keeping score, and she did it every day for years while he was too small to give her anything back.

◦ **Who chose you, who didn't have to? Say who.**

- Most people have somebody. It is worth saying out loud that they picked you — that it was never simply a job they were given.

SAY THIS ONE TOGETHER

•◦

**She fed him first. He
never forgot it.**



Then the hadith card.

FIRST EDITION • 13/39

IMAM ALI SAID

**“Keep Allah in view in the
matter of orphans. So do not
allow them to starve and
they should not be ruined in
your presence.”**

Imam Ali

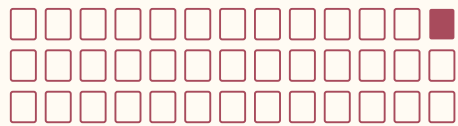


NOT A SILSILA SEGMENT • THIS SET HAS ITS OWN CHAIN

NOOR POST · EVERYONE ELSE

The other chain

The box holds fourteen cards, one for each of the Fourteen.
This set is the people around them: thirty-nine cards, collected
in any order.



First edition · thirty-nine cards

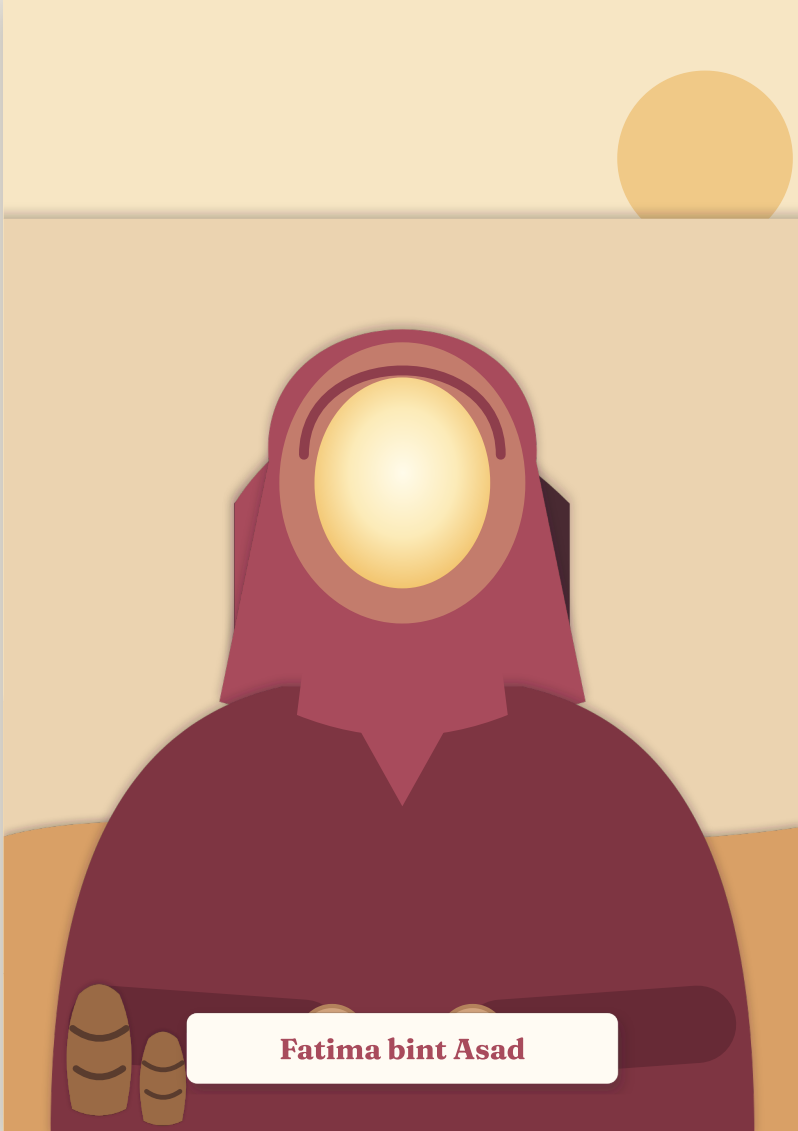
IN OUR WORDS

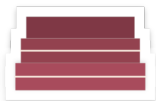
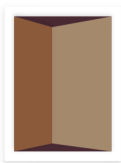
**Look after children who have no
parents. Never let them go hungry or be
left to struggle while you are there.**

Noor Post's own words, not the translation.

Nahj al-Balagha, Letter 47. Translated by Sayed Ali Reza.

Back — its own chain, no silsila number







**We opened this one
together.**

• _____

○ _____

Post it back to us, or keep it. Either is right.

STAMP

Noor Post

[Return address — not set]
